



Centre for Tropical Medicine and Global Health
Nuffield Department of Medicine
University of Oxford

Placement Information
for Prospective Placement Supervisors
Trinity Term 2026
(Term 3)

Academic Year 2025-26



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Thank you for expressing an interest in offering a placement project for our MSc in International Health and Tropical Medicine students commencing their studies in October 2025. Your time and commitment are very much appreciated.

The placements take place in the third term (Trinity Term) of the academic year for a period of approximately eight weeks (May - June inclusive). The student will then write a 10,000-word dissertation related to their placement, due mid-August.

This booklet contains general information about the course, specific details about the placement and highlights key dates. To host a placement, please complete the [online Placement Research Project Form](#) (please use a separate form for each project you wish to offer).

If you have questions or wish to discuss the suitability of placement projects, please feel free to contact me.

Sincerely,

Proochista Ariana
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Course Overview

The MSc in International Health and Tropical Medical (IHTM) is a full-time one-year multidisciplinary and interdisciplinary programme examining major challenges to the health of populations in resource-limited contexts. The course embraces the breadth and complexity of global health challenges facing resource-limited settings and equips candidates with the tools and awareness to contribute to innovative solutions.

The course aims to develop students:

- capacity to lead and work in multidisciplinary teams to tackle health challenges in resource-limited settings
- ability to apply an ethical approach to address inequities
- foundational skills in research techniques applied in the analysis of global health challenges
- capacity to critically appraise evidence in global health
- skills and practical experience in research

Upon completion of the course, students can continue to advance their knowledge, understanding and skills further in research or professional practice in the field of global health. Our graduates have gone on to leadership and research positions within institutions in their home countries and with major international health organisations. We have a growing alumni network of 221 students from 65 different countries and a broad range of disciplines from anthropology to engineering to medicine.

Course Structure

In the first term (Michaelmas Term), the course introduces the breadth of topics in, and methods applicable to global health. In the second term (Hilary Term), students take two modules from a choice of options ranging from international development to vaccinology. The third term (Trinity Term) provides students with the unique opportunity to apply their skills and gain first-hand experience in a global health project in a resource limited setting. Students will then produce a 10,000-word dissertation related to their Placement Research Project.

Michaelmas Term 2025

The first term will consist of core topics on research methods, an overview of some major global health challenges, and topics related to the research and practice of global health. Core modules include:

- **Paradigms and Tools for Global Health:** This module will cover epidemiology, statistics, health economics, social sciences for health, R and reproducible research. Methodological paradigms in the health and social sciences will be introduced and basic tools provided for each. Upon completion of this module, students will be able to critically review published literature covering a wide range of global health topics and can opt to further their application skills through the third term placement project.
- **Challenges and Change in International Health:** This module will cover some of the key health challenges found in resource limited contexts. Topics include communicable and non-communicable diseases as well as the life course. Upon completion of this module, students will have a broad awareness of the kinds of factors affecting international health, their challenges, solutions that have worked and current efforts to affect change.
- **Global Health Research and Practice:** This module highlights some of the important considerations in the research or practice of global health. Topics covered include ethics and governance, health systems and policy, antimicrobial resistance and medicine quality. Upon completion of this module, students will have an appreciation of the challenges and opportunities in global health research and practice.

In addition to the three modules, there is a Leadership, Management and Communication programme running through the year which provides students with skills in communicating with the media (written, radio and television), communicating with policy makers (written and oral), and communicating with the public. They also have training in debate, negotiation, stakeholder management, team management as well as support with academic writing including best practices in use of generative AI.

Hilary Term 2026

During the second term, in addition to some continued core content, students can select two modules from the following six modules for further study:

1. **Vaccinology** (module lead: Prof Adrian Hill): The module examines the science of vaccine development and the challenge of its application in real world contexts. The content will cover advances at the cutting edge of vaccine development.
2. **International Development and Health** (Module lead: Prof Proochista Ariana): This module, aims to introduce students to the important linkages between processes of development (political and economic) and health. The module challenges conventional health thinking and compels a broader consideration of the inter-related factors affecting the health of populations.
3. **Development, Environment and Health** (Module leads: Prof Katrina Charles and Prof Proochista Ariana) (in collaboration with SoGE): This innovative module brings together students (and teachers) from Geography, Development and Global Health to engage with a series of cases illustrating the intersection between processes of development, environmental changes and human health.
4. **Introduction to Mathematical Modelling of Infectious Diseases** (module lead: Prof Wirichada Pan-Ngum): This module provides a practical introduction to the mathematical modelling of infectious diseases. Mathematical modelling is being used with increasing frequency and scope to address questions about infectious diseases both in terms of basic science and in terms of national and international policy-making. This module provides basic practical skills which establish a foundation for further research or facilitate critical appraisal of mathematical modelling appearing in the scientific and grey literature.
5. **Health Innovation and Entrepreneurship** (module lead: Prof Bruno Holthof): This module is intended for those who want to drive change and innovation in small or larger organisations (non-profit, for profit or social profit). The module will focus on how to improve the health and wellbeing of patients and populations by adopting innovation in a constrained financial environment. The sessions will cover the core elements needed in a business plan and during the elective students will develop and present a business plan for one of their ideas. A case-based design will be used with cases focused on innovations in low resource contexts. The sessions build on and deepen the learning acquired in the core modules (e.g. Health Systems and Policy Research and Leadership, Management and Communication Training).
6. **Pandemic Sciences** (module lead: Prof Alice Norton): This module is intended for students interested in understanding and responding to epidemics and pandemics, particularly in low-resource settings. It will explore the biological and social drivers of infectious disease emergence, mechanisms for outbreak detection and response, and the challenges posed by governance, ethics, and research prioritisation during public health emergencies. The sessions will also examine how mathematical modelling supports decision-making, and how medical countermeasures are rapidly evaluated in crisis contexts. A case-based approach will be used to explore real-world outbreaks, drawing on expertise from the Pandemic Sciences Institute. The module builds on learning from core modules such as Health Systems and Policy Research and Global Health Research and Practice, and provides students with the opportunity to critically engage with the operational, research, and policy aspects of pandemic preparedness and response.

Trinity Term 2026

The third term will involve a funded eight-week placement with a global health project in a resource limited setting. Projects represent the range of subjects covered in the course. The placements are intended to provide an opportunity for students to apply what they have learned in the first two terms of the course. Students, with advice from their academic advisers, may choose from the placements available or, under special circumstances, propose their own placement (providing it meets course guidelines).

Criteria for Hosting a Placement

A Placement Project must meet the following criteria to be considered suitable:

1. Provision of an appropriate activity (in terms of scope and learning objectives) for 8 weeks suitable to contribute to a 10,000-word dissertation.
2. Provision of academic support and a named supervisor (and co-supervisor if primary supervisor will be too busy or travelling) with experience in supervision of postgraduates
 - a. Capacity to help student develop the research project proposal during Term 2 (Hilary term)
 - b. Capacity to provide at least one hour's supervision every week (at least 8 hours during the duration of the placement)
 - c. Capacity and time to provide written and oral feedback on at least one (and not more than two) dissertation draft(s)
3. Provision of logistic support, including recommendation for safe and appropriate accommodation (overseas placements only)
4. Access to basic IT facilities and scientific literature
5. Willingness to involve student in broader team activities

Placement Intended Learning Outcomes

Through the placement, students ought to be able to:

- Apply knowledge and skills gained in first two terms to a global health research project
- Experience the challenges and opportunities of conducting research in a resource limited context
- Work as a productive member of a team
- Appropriately contextualise research to setting (i.e. learn about the context within which the research is conducted).

The Dissertation

The placement project will form the basis of a 10,000-word dissertation to be submitted six weeks upon return from placement (mid-August).

Dissertation Intended Learning Outcomes

Through submission of the dissertation, students ought to be able to:

- Critically analyse literature
- Pose appropriate research questions
- Demonstrate sound use of methodology to address questions posed
- Appropriately interpret and critically engage with findings
- Demonstrate consideration of ethical issues involved in the research
- Produce a comprehensive report of the fieldwork and related findings

Allocation of the Placements

In early October, students will have access, via Canvas (our Virtual Learning Environment), to a list of placement research projects on offer for Trinity Term 2026. We advise students to contact placement supervisors to find out more about the proposed projects and express their interest. Please be prepared to receive emails from October 2025 to November 2025 from the students. You are welcome to ask interested students to submit CVs or outline their past experience for your consideration. But please note that allocations take place through the IHTM Placement Committee in December.

The students are asked to submit a list of their preferred three placements in order of preference by **Friday 28th November 2025**. These are reviewed by the IHTM Placement Committee and Course Director who will then contact hosts to discuss interested student(s). Once agreed, a formal email will be dispatched to you, the student and their Academic Adviser by **Friday 19th December 2025**.

Next Stage

Once you have been notified of the student(s) you will be hosting, please make contact with them (either via email or Zoom/Teams) to discuss the proposed placement. You may then direct the student(s) to background reading and provide them with relevant datasets. The students will be expected to produce a research proposal by the end of HT. The proposal, due on **Monday 16th March 2026**, requires students to prepare a brief literature review to identify research gaps, pose a set of research questions and outline the proposed methodology. Students are also required to outline the relevant ethical considerations. We ask that you please read at least one full draft of the proposal (but not more than two), in coordination with the students' Academic Advisors in advance of the submission on 16th March 2026.

Visa, Travel, Accommodation Arrangements and Risk Assessment

It is the responsibility of the student to ensure they have applied for the correct visa and to finalise their accommodation and flights. They are also responsible for acquiring the necessary vaccinations and completing the Risk Assessment and University Travel Insurance forms on time.

Please direct the student to whom they need to liaise with regards to visa and accommodation logistics. If you are able to offer low-cost accommodation for the duration of the placement, please let us know when offering a placement so we can assist the students with their budget.

The University has a statutory duty of care to ensure, as far as reasonably practicable, the health and safety of its staff and students whilst they are undertaking activities on behalf of the University. An important component of this is the risk assessment that the students need to complete prior to applying for University Travel Insurance. We ask that you please provide guidance and advice to the student on their risk assessment.

Responsibilities of Placement Supervisor

As a placement supervisor, your responsibilities will include the following:

1. Once placements have been confirmed (by Friday 19th December 2025), you will be asked to establish contact with the student and their Academic Adviser to discuss the project, the appropriate scope for the student and a schedule of coordinated feedback of the research proposal in second term.
2. Provide supervision and guidance (either via email or Zoom/Teams) as students prepare their research proposals. This may include direction to relevant literature as well as documents related to the project within which the placement project is embedded. We also request your feedback on the research questions and comments on at least one and no more than two draft(s) of the research proposal in coordination with the student's Academic Adviser (in advance of the due date: Monday 16th March 2026).
3. Provide advice and guidance to student to assist them in completing their Risk Assessment and Ethical Considerations.
4. Provide supervision and guidance to the student while on the placement (between May and June 2025 inclusive). We ask that you meet with the student at least once every week and a named co-supervisor is accessible for informal support and guidance daily. This would involve feedback on activities undertaken and any analysis conducted.
5. Contact the student's Academic Adviser near the end of the placement (or more frequently as may be needed) to discuss the student's performance during the placement and the dissertation structure.
6. Provide feedback on at least one (and not more than two) full draft(s) of the dissertation related to the research project in coordination with the student's Academic Adviser.
7. Upon completion of the dissertation, complete the form provided concerning the student's placement project and their performance during the placement.

If you are in Oxford during the week commencing 22nd June 2026, you are welcome to attend your student(s) Post Placement Presentation. Please notify the IHTM Admin team of your availability during that week.

Responsibilities of Placement Student

1. Once assigned a placement, the student shall contact the Placement Supervisor(s) to obtain the relevant information and related literature and begin discussion regarding appropriate research questions.
2. Draft the research proposal in Hilary Term with feedback from Placement Supervisor and Academic Adviser. This is due Monday 16th March.
3. Ensure that the Academic Adviser and Placement Supervisor are in communication and communications with one are summarised and conveyed to the other.
4. Ensure relevant vaccines are acquired in a timely fashion before travelling. We would strongly advise you contact the University Occupational Health once your placement is confirmed.
<https://www.admin.ox.ac.uk/uohs/travelhealth/>
5. Sub-let Oxford accommodation for the third term if appropriate.
6. Seek assistance from your placement supervisor when completing the Risk Assessment Form (available on Canvas under 'Placements'. Please make sure that you do not just copy and paste from the <https://www.gov.uk/foreign-travel-advice> site but think about the risks and what you would put in place before travelling to your placement. This will need to be completed and uploaded to the Travel Insurance Website <http://www.admin.ox.ac.uk/finance/insurance/travel/>. Please ensure that dates and information on the Risk Assessment Form are consistent with your flight and accommodation information. Discrepancies will delay the approval of your travel insurance.
7. Once flight and accommodation have been confirmed, and RAF completed, apply for University Travel Insurance. Please note that your travel is not approved until the insurance is in place.
8. Prepare an oral presentation of your research proposal to an expert panel on **Friday 20th March 2026**.
9. While on placement, function as an active contributor to the host team and be respectful of cultural norms and governance structures within the organisation. Refrain from seeking input from others at the placement site unless specifically approved by your placement supervisor (since individuals are very busy and too much input may be more confusing than helpful).
10. Conduct the fieldwork as directed by your Placement Supervisor(s) and agreed with your Academic Adviser as appropriate for the scope of your IHTM dissertation.
11. Provide your Academic Adviser and Placement Supervisor with brief weekly updates on your activities, challenges you have encountered and strategies for addressing them.
12. Arrange a meeting with your Academic Adviser upon your return from placement to discuss the dissertation structure and schedule of drafts. It may be advisable to coordinate a call that includes both your Academic Adviser and Placement Supervisor. You will want to arrange this meeting prior to your return as your Academic Advisers may be very busy and will need to plan well in advance.
13. Coordinate a schedule for feedback from your Placement Supervisor and Academic Adviser being conscious of busy schedules and holidays. Please note that both your Placement Supervisor and Academic Adviser have agreed to read a draft of your dissertation but it is important that you facilitate coordinated feedback. If seeking input from others in the drafting of your dissertation, please first consult your Academic Adviser for their approval and recommendation.
14. Prepare Post Placement presentation describing your placement project, your experience with the placement, your preliminary findings, and the proposed structure of your dissertation.
15. Give a Post Placement Presentation to your fellow colleagues and Academic Adviser during W/C 22nd June 2026.
16. Format your dissertation and submit on time! Any delays will cost you a deduction of marks as detailed in the examination conventions.

Responsibilities of Academic Adviser

Each student has an Academic Adviser appointed to them at the start of the academic year. The Academic Adviser will support the student with the dissertation writing (even where they are not an expert in the field). Responsibilities of the academic advisor are as follows:

1. Guide student's choice of a placement. Liaise with the Course Director as appropriate.
2. Once the placements are assigned. Communicate with the Placement Supervisor to ensure the feedback and the scope of the project is agreed and appropriate for the scope of the IHTM dissertation (please consult with the Course Director if unsure).
3. Provide advice and constructive feedback on the student's research proposal during Hilary Term. You are asked to read at least one full draft (and not more than two drafts) of the proposal before its submission. Please coordinate your feedback with the Placement Supervisor to avoid confusing the student with mixed input. Deadline for the students to submit their research proposal is Monday 16th March 2026.
4. Read weekly emails from the student during their placement (April 2026 - June 2026 inclusive) and respond to any problems that may need your input. If there are any major issues, please consult with the Course Director.
5. Communicate with the Placement Supervisor near the end of the placement and to discuss the dissertation structure and agree a schedule of feedback for the student.
6. Meet with your student upon their return from their placement to discuss the structure of the dissertation and set dates for drafts and meetings leading up to their submission in mid-August.
7. Read at least one (and not more than two) full draft(s) of the dissertation and meet with your student to provide productive feedback prior to submission.
8. Be available for student post placement presentations which will take place Week 9 of Trinity Term.

Placement Key Dates (2025-26)

Michaelmas Term 2025	
Students have access to list of Research Projects via Canvas	Early October 2025
Students submit their placement preference form	Friday 28th November 2025
Students, Academic Advisers and Placement Supervisors notified of confirmed placements	Friday 19th December 2025 (or soon thereafter)
Hilary Term 2026	
Students to contact Occupational Health with regards to vaccinations and other health considerations	At least four weeks before travelling to placement
Students to submit University Travel insurance and Risk Assessment Forms	Dates to be confirmed but no later than four weeks before travel
Students submit their Research Proposals	Monday 16th March 2026
Students Pre-Placement Presentations (Grant Application Proposal – Funders Day)	Friday 20th March 2026
Students' Placements	End of April 2026 - end of June 2026
Students' Post-Placement Presentations	22nd - 26th June 2026
Long Vacation 2026	
Submission of Dissertation	Monday 10th August 2026